THE EFFECT OF DAILY SCREEN TIME ON ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE OF BASIC SEVEN STUDENTS IN EDEN ACADEMY SCHOOL.

1. INTRODUCTION

The use of digital devices such as smartphones, tablets, televisions and computers has become common among Junior High School students. While these devices support learning, excessive daily screen time is a growing concern for teachers and parents at Eden Academy. Teachers have observed that some Basic 7 students spend 4-6 hours daily on TikTok, games, and YouTube, leading to late submission of homework, sleeping in class and low test scores.

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT.

Academic performance of some Basic 7 students at Eden Academy has declined in the 2024/2025 academic year. Preliminary observation suggests a link between high daily recreational screen time and poor performance. This action research seeks to investigate this effect and propose interventions.

3. PURPOSE / OBJECTIVES.

i. To determine the average daily screen time of Basic 7 students.

ii. To examine the relationship between daily screen time and academic performance.

iii. To identify the main screen activities students engage in.

iv. To suggest strategies to manage screen time for better performance.

4. RESEARCH QUESTIONS

i. What is the average daily screen time of Basic 7 students?

ii. How does daily screen time affect academic performance?

iii. What are the dominant screen activities among the students?

iv. What measures can help reduce negative effects of screen time?

5. LITERATURE REVIEW

Literature shows that moderate use of educational technology enhances learning (Livingstone, 2019). However, excessive recreational screen time of more than 2 hours per day is associated with reduced attention, poor sleep and lower GPA (Twenge & Campbell, 2018). Carter et al. (2020) found that students who spend more than 3 hours on social media daily had lower academic engagement. In Ghana, Agyemang (2021) reported that JHS students in urban schools who used phones at night recorded lower BECE mock scores.

6. METHODOLOGY

Research Design: Descriptive survey - action research design.

Population: All 30 Basic 7 students of Eden Academy School.

Sample & Sampling: 30 students selected using simple random sampling.

Instruments: Questionnaire on daily screen time, interview guide for 5 teachers, and students' end-of-term average scores.

Data Collection: Data collected within one week.

Data Analysis: Data analyzed using frequencies, percentages and mean. Comparison of screen time categories with average scores.

7. FINDINGS

i. Average daily screen time: 35% spent 1-2 hours, 40% spent 3-4 hours, 25% spent above 5 hours daily.

ii. Academic performance: Students with 1-2 hours screen time had average score of 72%. Those with 3-4 hours had 61%, and those above 5 hours had 52%.

iii. Dominant activities: 45% TikTok/YouTube, 30% Mobile games, 15% WhatsApp/Facebook, 10% Educational research.

iv. Teachers reported late homework, lack of concentration and sleepiness among high screen time users.

8. DISCUSSION

The findings show a negative relationship between excessive recreational screen time and academic performance. Students with controlled screen time performed better, confirming Twenge & Campbell (2018) and Agyemang (2021). The problem is not the device itself but the unregulated, entertainment-focused use.

9. ACTION TAKEN / RECOMMENDATIONS

i. Organize PTA sensitization on screen time regulation at home.

ii. Implement a "Screen Time Diary" for Basic 7 students to track usage.

iii. School rule: No phones during prep and class hours.

iv. Guidance and counselling sessions on digital discipline and study timetables.

v. Encourage educational use of devices under parental control.

10. CONCLUSION

Excessive daily recreational screen time negatively affects the academic performance of Basic 7 students of Eden Academy. With collaborative effort from teachers, parents and students, screen time can be regulated to improve learning outcomes.

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